Lesson 28

Divine Healing Part 3 – Soul Sickness

Aim: To share the biblical concept and blessing of Divine Healing.

Introduction:

The meaning of the Greek word “sozo” (salvation) includes the idea of health, healing and wholeness for spirit, soul and body.

Sickness of the soul is a common problem of mankind. Soul sickness or soul injury is referred to by the term "broken-hearted." This term issued to describe the inner hurts of the soul.

Jesus said: "… the Spirit of the Lord is upon me… to heal the broken-hearted [wounded soul]"

We are told in the Twenty-third Psalm that the Good Shepherd of our lives will "restore" our souls.

This is an important topic, for whatever destroys the soul can finally destroy the body. Sickness of soul can produce sickness of body. A breakdown of the emotions and mind will lead to a breakdown in the body. We truly need to have our souls restored.

As we have seen, the functions of the soul include our mind, emotions, imagination and even our memories.

Many Christians suffer from scars on their souls. They retain many painful memories from the past. As a result, they doubt the present and fear the future. They may have answers in their heads, but it is hard to think straight when one's heart is hurting.

I think we all would agree that many of us need an "inner healing" of the soul. Our minds, memories and emotions need to be made whole. I have called this the "release of the soul."

A. GOD WANTS US WHOLE

Healing of the whole man is a process. It begins by meeting Jesus as our Savior and our Baptizer in the Holy Spirit. This results in our having a new heart and a free spirit.

God always starts at the center of our being- that is, our spirit. He first touches our spirit with His Spirit. After our spirit is released, our soul can be restored.

God begins in our spirit (sometimes called the inner-man or innermost being; see John 7:37, 38). Then He desires to work His way into our soul to heal and restore it.

He wishes to bring His life and healing power to our spirit, soul and body– that we might be "blameless" (sound and complete) when He comes.

1. Spirit, Soul and Body: Our Health

As we have said, the functions of the spirit, soul and body are related to one another. A healthy "spirit" is the sound foundation for a healthy "soul". healthy "soul" favors a healthy "body."

It works the other way as well. It is difficult to be at our best spiritually if we are emotionally or physically sick. If we are ill in mind or body, it can affect our work and witness for God. Our relationship with God's Spirit is safe and secure, but the flow of His Spirit through our lives to the world can be limited.

We have been created to function as "whole" persons. I believe the Apostle John refers to this truth in one of his letters: *"Dear friend, I pray that you may prosper and be in health even as your soul prospers"*-3 John 2.

This verse teaches us that physical health is related to the well-being of one's soul. In other words, a healthy soul-life is necessary for a healthy body-life.

2. Spirit, Soul and Body: Our Healing

Our bodies tend to follow the lead which is taken by our souls. And our souls follow the lead taken by our spirits.

Spiritual (spirit) problem produces mental and emotional (soul) problems; these in turn produce physical (body) problems. The links between our spirit, soul and body truly form an unbroken chain.

One cannot solve a psychological (soul) problem by treating the body alone. Likewise, one cannot solve a spiritual problem by dealing only with the mind or emotions.

This is why some treatments by doctors and psychologists fail. The root reasons in the soul and/or spirit which are producing the problems have not been rooted out.

This is true even of healing prayer in some cases of bodily disease. After prayer, the person may seem to be healed. Body pain and physical symptoms may be gone for a time. However, if deep needs of the soul (emotions)

and spirit have not been met, physical problems may soon show up again.

I have seen this happen many times in the ministry of the healing-evangelists. Many people have been totally healed and have never suffered from their physical problems again.

However, others have kept coming back for prayer. They kept "losing" their healing after a short period of time.

Many in the ministry are not aware of the deeper levels of need in the souls of the people.

Yes, God wants us well. He wants us to be whole in spirit, soul and body. But there must be total work of healing– one which moves from within to without (starting in the spirit, continuing into the soul and expressed finally in the body). Otherwise, only a limited or partial healing occurs which will not last. For this reason, we wish to study the kinds of hurt which can damage the soul of man.

B. SOUL SICKNESS

There are many things which can place lasting injury upon our souls.

I – CAUSED BY:

1. Our Parents.

For example, many children suffer because of the faults and failures of their parents. The Scriptures tell us that children are to be taught and trained in love (Eph. 6:4). Unkind, unfair or unwise words and actions can cause either fear or anger in the hearts of children.

a. Physical Abuse. Some parents are very harsh and critical. They never praise or encourage their children. Some even resort to physical abuse and cruel beatings. In such cases, it is not just the body which suffers. The soul (personality and emotions) can be severely damaged as well. These inner-scars are often carried into adult life.

b. Emotional Abuse. Far worse than the welts and wounds of physical abuse are the unseen wounds of overly critical parents which injure the soul. Those who have been hurt in this way grow up and become adults with many emotional problems. It affects their relationships with other people– in the family, at school and work, and even within the church.

Many children thus suffer from a very low sense of self-esteem. They cannot picture themselves being successful at anything. They are afraid to take on new duties or even prepare themselves for a better position in life.

They have been put down (berated or criticized) so many times, they have lost hope.

They live under a cloud of self-doubt and personal insecurity.

Everyone has a few feelings such as these from time to time. However, some have been damaged so badly, they cannot live a normal life.

2. Our Sins.

God's laws of love and morality were given for our well-being. They came from His Father-heart because He cares for His children. He gave us the rules (laws) to keep us from injury, hurt and pain. When we break His moral laws, this results in our hearts (soul) being broken. When you break God's laws, you end up with a broken (injured, wounded) heart (soul).

Not only do we suffer, but others suffer as well. Our sins affect others, and their sins affect us.

The consequence (result) of breaking God's law is often hurt and pain for innocent children. They are not to blame at all for their pain and suffering.

Did you have a parent who drank alcoholic beverages to excess? Such parents sometimes beat and injure their children in their drunken stupor. The child suffers (though innocent and guilty of no wrong-doing).

a. Sexual Sins. Moral sin and compromise also injure and damage the soul. The Old Testament strongly stated the truth in this way:

> *"Whoever commits adultery with a woman is a total fool, for he is destroying his own soul. He will be both wounded and disgraced– and his shame will never be wiped away"* - Proverbs 6:32, 33.

What Society Says. Sadly, modern society want to lift all moral limits in regard to sexual relationships. Some modern-day "fools" say that as long as no none objects, any kind of sexual activity is all right.

Adultery, homosexual activity, sex with children, and other shameful practices are not seen as wrong. They are all within the personal "rights" of each individual. Such activities are called marks of "maturity" and personal "freedom" by these modern-day moral lepers.

What God Says. God's Word plainly forbids such immoral behavior, and warns people of the painful results-both to the individual and to society.

God's principles of morality are for our well-being and personal happiness. They are also for the good of society as a whole.

To violate or break the laws of God does not bring true freedom. In fact, we come under a bondage which in the end will only lead to death and destruction.

In the downward process, there will be much pain at every level– spiritually, mentally, emotionally, and physically. This is true for the individual and for society as a whole.

Results. Modern society is already beginning to reap a horrible harvest from the sinful seeds it has sown: Broken homes, hearts and marriages; confused and abused children; unwed mothers and abortions; dread sexual disease.

And God grieves because man hurts. It is a pain which is produced by man's rebellion against God's divine laws of love. To ignore this truth is to invite tragedy– because all this immorality wounds and destroys the soul.

3. Other Sins. Further light on the causes of soul injury can be found in these words form the pen of the Apostle Peter:

a. What Scripture Says. *"Dear friends, you are only visitors in this world. Therefore, I beg you to resist and remove yourselves from the strong desires and lusts of the flesh. These things war [are the enemies which will destroy and fight] against your soul"*-1 Peter 2:11

Peter is saying that if we give in to the strong desires of the flesh, these sins (like enemy warriors) will seek to destroy our emotions, mind and thinking ability. As a result, the soul will be injured, bruised and broken.

b. Results. Our inner life rests upon a foundation of reason and emotion. When our emotions have been damaged, it is difficult to think properly. Painful memories are woven into our hearts and minds. We can't' clearly see or understand ourselves or others. The future is filled with fearful images.

Our imagination holds mental pictures or "images" of what is going to happen. The color and character of these pictures is controlled by the will-being of our soul life. When "it is well with our soul," the future is bright and filled with hope and faith.

However, if our minds, memories and emotions are still scarred by painful events of the past, the scene is quite different. The picture will be painted with the dark colors of fear, doubt, resentment, jealousy and self-pity.

No wonder a God of love gives us divine guidelines by which to live. He knows the pain we will suffer if we follow our own fleshly desires or lusts.

4. Works of the Flesh. In his letter to the Galatians, Paul lists some of the works of the flesh which can so severely damage the soul. We might do well to give them special attention (Galatians 5:19-21):

a. Adultery– sex with someone other than your spouse;

b. Fornication– sex with unmarried persons;

c. Uncleanness– impure thoughts, words and deeds, homosexuality;

d. Lasciviousness– selfish and shameless behavior;

e. Idolatry– worship of idols and false gods;

f. Witchcraft– the use of magical demonic power;

g. Hatred– bad temper;

h. Variance– trouble– making, fighting;

i. Emulations- being jealous;

j. Wrath– anger;

k. Strife– arguing;

l. Seditions– causing divisions;

m. Heresies– false teaching;

n. Envying– wanting what someone else has;

o. Murders– killing people;

p. Drunkenness– using strong drink(liquor/whiskey);

q. Reveling– wild and wasteful parties.

II. EFFECTS ON:

1. Ourselves. The works of the flesh are planned by the devil to damage the soul. We will be left weakened and wounded within. Our lives will be robbed, wasted and even destroyed. A nation which permits and encourages such "soulish" activities through magazines, newspapers and cinema films is committing social suicide. It is sowing the seeds of death and destruction among its people.

2. Our Society. At the personal level, the final results are mental, emotional and physical breakdowns. At the social level, moral standards fall and the crime rate rises.

This is the sad state in which we find much of our world today. Hospitals, prisons and other social

institutions are filled to overflowing. When the people of a nation are sick in their souls, all of society suffers as well.

III. WE HAVE A CHOICE

Jesus warned His disciples that the devil has come to *"steal and destroy."* He then declares: *"But I have come that you may have life-full and overflowing"*–John 10:10

1. Life or Death. The choice is clear: It is one between life and death– the fruit of the Spirit or the works of the flesh. When a society ignores or willfully breaks God's laws, it is opening the doors to the devil himself. The results are tragic at every level of life– whether it be the individual, family, community or nation.

"Blessed is the nation whose God is the Lord..."– Psalm 33:12. How sad it is when a nation founded on godly principles shuts God out of its public life. When moral values are lowered in the schools and on television, there is a price to pay. Sin is not cheap– it costs a great deal to serve the devil.

2. Draw Near to God. When we draw near to God, He draws near to us (Jas 4:8). When we shut God out of our lives, we shut ourselves off from the protection of His

presence. He will honor our choice and give us over to our wicked ways.

"God shows His anger from heaven. His anger is against evil and wicked men who push away the truth… So he gives them up to the fleshly lusts which dishonor their body… He gives them over to their evil ways… that they might get paid in their own souls and bodies the terrible penalty which they deserve"–Romans 1:18, 24, 26, 27

CONCLUSION

Yes, we see all around us the results of man's wicked ways. Sin is like a sword which pierces deep within the soul of man.

But there is hope. It is found in God's Word. In His grace, He has provided healing for man's sin scarred body and soul. He wants us well for both our good and His glory.